Earl Hickson Jr.

HCI Graduate Application CV

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RESEARCH PROFILE

UX Engineer and independent HCI practitioner with a background in graphic design, frontend engineering, and full-stack product development. My research interests focus on how interactive systems can support human capability across relationships, learning, privacy, and complex decision-making without unnecessarily replacing human agency.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-computer interaction / Learning technologies / Privacy and consent / Decision support / Information architecture / Accessibility / Human agency and automation

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATION

Bachelor of Fine Arts in Graphic Design

Kean University / Union, New Jersey / 2015

Graphic design training in visual communication, hierarchy, typography, and composition.

IBM Full Stack Software Developer Professional Certificate

IBM / Coursera / Verified December 2025

https://coursera.org/verify/professional-cert/ZD6SUR06VY2K

SELECTED HCI INVESTIGATIONS

WithYou - Independent HCI investigation

Privacy, consent, and relationships

Designed and implemented a beta-oriented relationship application and a focused sharing prototype. Known gap: one legacy endpoint retains earlier unconditional behavior. Proposed next methods: scope-comprehension testing, scenarios, and interviews.

DojoNet - Independent HCI investigation

Learning, reflection, and progression

Designed and implemented practitioner-facing learning surfaces and a qualitative progression prototype. Instructor workflows remain incomplete. Proposed next methods: diary study, observation, and instructor interviews.

Gundam Forge - Independent HCI investigation

Information architecture and decision support

Built a functional beta-oriented deck-building and playtesting system with continuous validation and a heuristic opponent. Proposed next methods: comparative decision tasks and think-aloud usability testing.

TECHNICAL PREPARATION

Methods used: Analytics review; Hotjar-informed evaluation; Accessibility audits; Interaction prototyping; Implementation analysis; Design-system evaluation; Technical usability review.

Interaction & product: User flows, information architecture, interaction design, prototyping, responsive design, design systems, accessibility

Frontend engineering: React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS, component architecture, state management

Backend & data: Node.js, Express, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Supabase, authentication, real-time systems

Quality & delivery: Behavior testing, Testing Library, Git/GitHub, CI/CD, Vite, deployment workflows

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Front-End Developer & Digital Integration Specialist
Jan 2025 - 2025

AMA Fight Club

Responsive web experience and digital integrations supporting prospective members, operations, and recruiting.

Front-End Developer
Dec 2023 - Oct 2024

Asembia

Reusable component architecture, accessibility practices, and information design across healthcare platforms.

Lead Designer & Front-End Developer
Nov 2021 - Mar 2023

BroadcastMed

Design and frontend delivery for healthcare marketing experiences within a proprietary CMS.

Freelance Front-End Developer
2019

Merck

Frontend development supporting digital marketing and communications initiatives.

Front-End Developer
2015 - 2016

Verizon Wireless

Consumer-facing digital interfaces and internal tools.

Digital Designer & Front-End Developer
2014 - 2015

KBS&P

Digital design and frontend development for enterprise clients at a New York advertising agency.

TEACHING AND LEADERSHIP

Teaching martial arts has shaped how I think about progressive instruction, feedback, observation, trust, adaptation, reflection, different learning styles, and capability under pressure.

Academy and dates require confirmation before publication as a formal experience entry.

SELECTED WRITING

Teaching Jiu-Jitsu Changed the Way I Think About UX
Field Notes / ehicksonjr.com/field-notes

Learning, feedback, reflection, and the difference between information transfer and capability.

Designing Consent Into Digital Products
Field Notes / ehicksonjr.com/field-notes

Privacy architecture, field-level visibility, and the gap between interface promises and implementation paths.

What Trading Card Games Teach Us About Information Architecture
Field Notes / ehicksonjr.com/field-notes

Recognition, constraint timing, and decision support without replacing player judgment.

METHODS SOUGHT THROUGH FORMAL STUDY

Semi-structured interviews / Usability testing / Diary studies / Contextual inquiry / Observational research / Qualitative coding / Experimental design / Research ethics / Mixed-method evaluation

These methods are training goals and proposed evaluation directions, not completed research claims.